McMurdo Station, Ross Island

BUILDING INFORMATION SHEET

Balloon Inflation Tower

Location ID: B082

This building, which is composed of two connected buildings, is used for weather balloon storage, preparation, inflation, and launch. Building 81, which is now connected to Building 82, was originally constructed to house a hydrogen generator used to inflate the balloons. The generator has since been removed. Building 82 is a high-bay facility used for storage, preheating, inflating, and launching.



Photo 1: *Balloon Inflation Tower*

General Structure Information

Usage	Balloon inflation and storage facility
Occupancy Group	H-2 Hazardous
Maximum Occupancy	6
Construction Type	Type V, N, combustible; insulated T-5 plywood panel structure with supplementary steel framing (Building 82), wood-framed plywood exterior walls and roof (Building 81), wood-framed plywood floor and interior partitions.
Year Constructed	1960 (Building 82), 1985/86 (Building 81)
Dimensions	20' x 20', 16' x 16

Floor Area

Floor	Area
Floor 1	656 sq ft
Total	656 sq ft

HVAC System

Heating	One Dornback forced-air, oil-burning unit (120,000 Btu/hr).
Air Handling Units	None

Fuel Tank	300 gallon fuel tank

Water and Sewer

Water Service	Not connected
Sewer Service	Not connected
Connections	Sinks: 0 Toilets: 0 Urinals: 0 Showers: 0 Water Fountains: 0
Water Heater	None

Electrical Service

Service Feeder	Feeder A
Electrical Service	208/120V, 3PH, 100A, Class 1, Division 1 interior electrical

Fire System

Fire Panel Type	King-Fisher KFRTI-20 industrial radio and control system (IRACS) panel, heat detectors, pull station
Heat Detectors	Located throughout building
Suppression Type	Automatic dry-chemical fire extinguisher in furnace room.

Floorplans

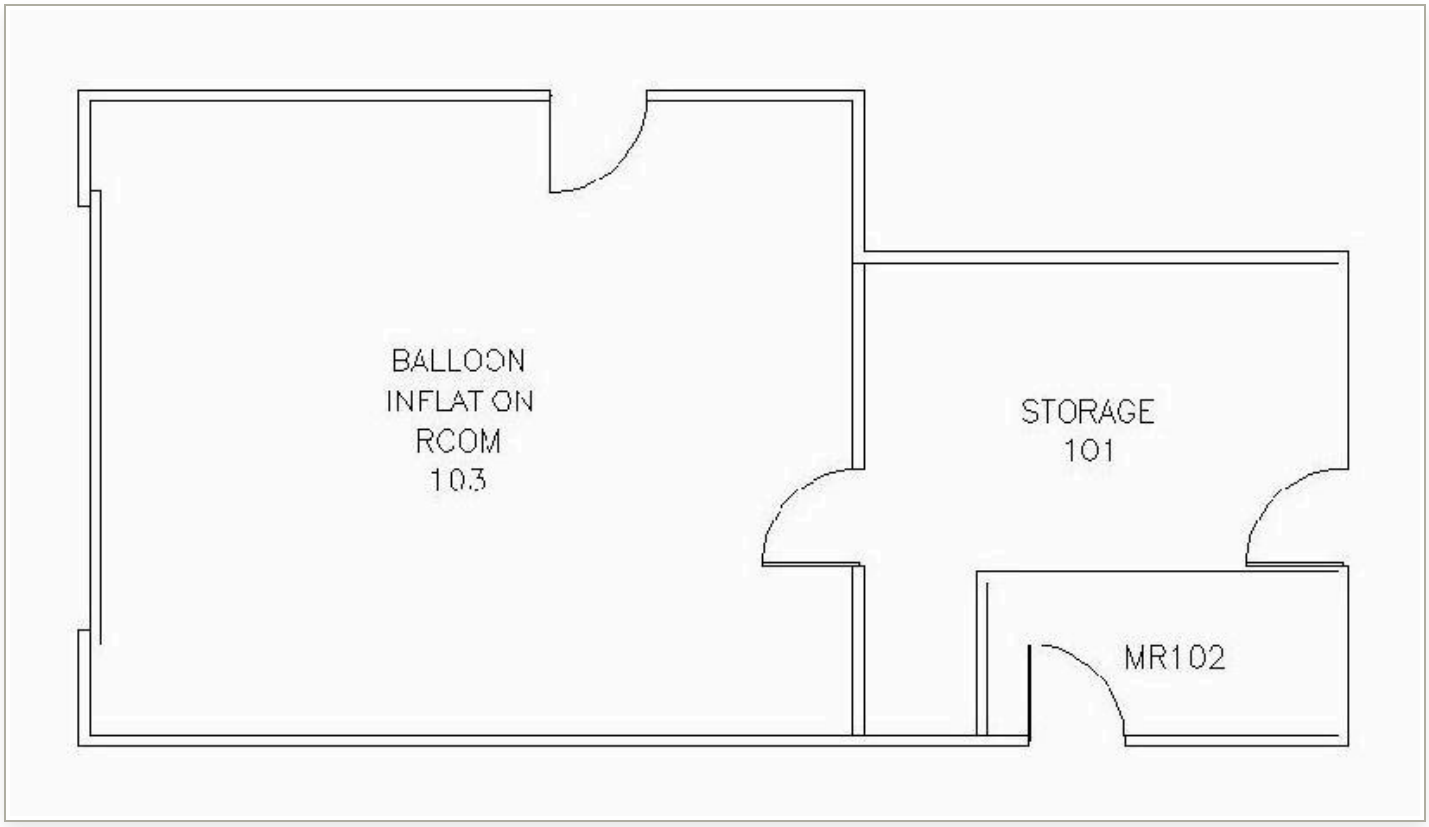


Figure 1: *Balloon Inflation Tower*